ALYSSA RUSONIK

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Canadian citizen ◇ Born: 10/2000

EDUCATION

PhD in Finance, HEC Paris — *2022-2027 (expected)*
Under the supervision of Jean-Edouard Colliard and Itzhak Gilboa

Junior Visiting Scholar, Nuffield College, Oxford — *April-May, 2025*
Under the supervision of Margaret Meyer

Visiting Student, Toulouse School of Economics — *March-April, 2025*
Under the supervision of Sébastien Pouget

BSc in Mathematics and Economics (minor in History), University of Toronto — *2018-2022*
Senior thesis under the supervision of Aloysius Siow

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Financial Economics, Decision Theory, Behavioral
Secondary: Economic and Financial History

REFERENCES

Jean-Edouard Colliard (Advisor)
HEC Paris
colliard@hec.fr

Thierry Foucault
HEC Paris
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Itzhak Gilboa (Co-Advisor)
HEC Paris
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Larry Samuelson
Yale University
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Irina Zviadadze
HEC Paris
zviadadze@hec.fr

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Narrative Cacophony in Financial Markets" **(Job Market Paper)**

Awards: AF2I (French Association of Institutional Investors) Young Researcher Grant

Abstract: I develop a methodology for extracting "narratives – clusters of "stories similar in meaning – from unstructured text. Applying it to 21,771 news articles from the 2025 "Liberation Day" episode, I study how stock prices aggregate information through narratives. I define "narrative cacophony" as the presence of many salient narratives with contradictory pricing implications. I document that narrative cacophony dampens trade and propose a theoretical rationalization. Moreover, when this happens, the R^2 of returns by narrative-induced beliefs and by CAPM falls (by 26 and 27p.p., respectively). Similarly, the aggregation of narrative information slows: a delayed pricing-in effect obtains. Because markets aggregate information and update prices through agents' trades, these

findings suggest that narrative cacophony which stifles trading makes prices incorporate information less effectively.

Presentations: 22nd Olin Finance Conference at Washington University in St. Louis (PhD session, 2026, scheduled); Tilburg University (Finance, 2026); Toulouse School of Economics (Finance, 2026; PhD Seminar, 2025); HEC Paris (Finance, 2026; Economics, 2026; 10th PhD Workshop in Memory of Denis Gromb, 2026); Future Finance Fest (2026); ICMS Workshop on AI and Economics (2026); Bocconi (Theory and Experiments Seminar, 2026); Time, Uncertainties and Strategies XI (2025); Beliefs, Narratives, and Memory Workshop (2025); Parisian Behavioral Economics Symposium (2025); Oxford (PhD Seminar 2025).

WORKING PAPERS

"Institutional Commitment and Economic Revival: Evidence from Palace-Building in Renaissance Rome"

Awards: Georges Gallais-Hamonno Prize in Historical Finance; Frank D. Lewis Memorial Prize in Economic History; Arthur Hosios Award.

Abstract: I study the recovery of the Roman economy following the papacys absence (1309-1377), specifically, an era of palace-building resulting in the construction of over 31% of palaces built in Roman history. Using a novel dataset, I show that the late-15th century palace-construction boom was triggered by credible institutional commitment. A reform of inheritance laws (1475) allowed prelates to bequeath their possessions, causing a significant increase of prelate palace-building. Initial prelate investment guaranteed the papacy would remain in Rome long-term, which eventually incentivized laymen to invest. I disentangle the effect of commitment to long-term presence from contemporaneous papal presence to show that the irreversibility of institutional change is a necessary condition for successful intervention.

Presentations: Paris School of Economics (Economic History Seminar, 2026); Ludwig Maximilian University of Munich (PhD Seminar, 2025); EEA Congress (2025); Oxford (PhD Seminar, 2025); ENS Paris-Saclay (CEPS Seminar, 2025); Toulouse School of Economics (PhD Seminar, 2025); Early Modern Rome V (2024); Sixteenth Century Society Conference (2024); Canadian Network for Economic History Conference (2024); CREST (Economics, 2024); HEC Economics PhD Conference (2023); "All in the Family" Conference in Honor of Aloysius Siow (2023); University of Toronto (PhD Seminar, 2022).

"Lexitarianism: A Needs-Based Approach to Public Policy" with Itzhak Gilboa and Larry Samuelson

Abstract: Utilitarian models typically do not attempt to distinguish between wants and needs, and they assume that all determinants of well-being are commensurate. In contrast, welfare policies seem to reflect these distinctions. We propose to bridge the gap between utilitarian theory and economic practice by introducing *lexitarianism*: the maximization of a vector of lexicographically-ordered welfare functions, as applied to needs. We propose a formulation of the social welfare problem based on the concept of a position and use it to axiomatize lexitarianism as well as its extensions to multiple time periods and uncertainty.

Presentations: Econometric Society European Winter Meeting* (2026, scheduled); D-TEA (2026); RUD (2026); Normative Economics and Economic Policy seminar* (2026).

*Presentation by coauthor.

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Prospective and Retrospective Valuation of Financial Information" with Yves Le Yaouanq and Peter Schwardmann

SEMINARS & CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Only own presentations listed.

2026: *Seminars:* PSE Economic History Seminar; Bocconi Theory and Experiments Seminar; TSE Finance; Tilburg Finance; HEC Paris Finance; HEC Paris Economics.

Conferences: ICMS Workshop on AI and Economics; D-TEA; RUD; Future Finance Fest; 10th HEC Paris Finance PhD Workshop in Memory of Denis Gromb; 22nd Olin Finance Conference at Washington University in St. Louis (PhD session, scheduled).

2025: *Seminars:* TSE-TSM PhD Workshop $\times$ 2; CEPS Seminar (ENS Paris-Saclay); Oxford Student Research Workshop in Micro Theory; Oxford Economic and Social History Graduate Workshop; HEC Paris Finance; LMU PhD Student Brownbag.

Conferences: Parisian Behavioral Economics Symposium; EEA Congress 2025; Beliefs, Narratives, and Memory Workshop; Time, Uncertainties and Strategies XI.

2024: *Seminars:* CREST Internal Seminar; HEC Paris.

Conferences: Regional and Urban Economics Seminar (PSE, Discussant); Sixteenth Century Society Conference; Early Modern Rome V.

2023: "All in the Family" Conference in Honour of Aloysius Siow (University of Toronto); HEC Economics PhD Conference (HEC Paris); Canadian Network for Economic History Conference.

2022: University of Toronto PhD Brownbag.

HONORS & AWARDS

AF2I (French Association of Institutional Investors) Young Researcher Grant	*2026*
Georges Gallais-Hamonno Prize in Historical Finance	*2025*
Frank D. Lewis Memorial Prize in Economic History	*2023*
Arthur Hosios Award	*2022*
HEC Paris Scholarship of Excellence *(five-year scholarship)*	*2022*
HEC Paris Foundation Scholarship *(five-year scholarship)*	*2022*
Undergraduate Research Grant *(Department of Economics, University of Toronto)*	*2022*
Trinity College Experiential Funding *(research grant from the Provost's Experiential Fund)*	*2022*
Provost's Scholar *(University of Toronto)*	*2022*
University of Toronto Excellence Award *(research supervisor: Peter Cziraki)*	*2021*
Fraser-Crawford Scholarship *(three-time recipient)*	*2019, 2020, 2021*
Margaret Ronald Taylor and Thomas Paxton Taylor Scholarship in Mathematics	*2020*
Myrtle V. McCulloch Prize in Renaissance Studies *(two-time recipient)*	*2019, 2020*
Ruth Robinson Leberg Book Prize in Political Science	*2020*
Rita K. Teetzel In-Course Scholarship	*2019*
University of Toronto Scholar *(awarded to top 100 UofT students)*	*2019*
RBC Canadian Universities Program Scholarship *(awarded annually to 50 students)*	*2018*
UofT National Scholarship *(full four-year scholarship; awarded to up to ten students)*	*2018*

PRE-PHD PUBLICATIONS

"Restricted Invertibility of Continuous Matrix Functions," with Adrian Fan, Jack Montemurro, Pavlos Motakis, Naina Praveen, Paul Skoufranis and Noam Tobin.
Operators and Matrices, 2022, 16(4): 1191-1217.

TEACHING

GRADUATE COURSES

HEC Paris, Finance Department:

- Financial Markets (Lecturer) *2024*
- Financial Markets (Teaching Assistant) *2023*
- Financial Economics (Teaching Assistant) *2023*

UNDERGRADUATE COURSES

University of Toronto, Department of Mathematics:

- MAT137: Calculus with Proofs (Head Teaching Assistant) *2021-2022*
- MAT237: Multivariable Calculus with Proofs (Teaching Assistant) *2020-2022*
- MAT137: Calculus with Proofs (Teaching Assistant) *2019-2021*

RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

- Research Assistant to Noémie Pinardon-Touati (Columbia University), *2022-2023*
- Fields Undergraduate Summer Research Program (Fields Institute) *July-August, 2021*
- Research Assistant to Peter Cziraki (University of Toronto) *May-August, 2021*
- Strategy Analyst, Bank of Montreal (BMO) *May-August, 2020*

LANGUAGES

English (native), Russian (native), French (fluent), Italian (intermediate).